



Diaspora looks 'neat' with its big pictures and news stream. The blog-post points to the following features:

- Share status messages and photos privately and in near real-time with your friends through 'aspects'.
- Be friends with people across the Internet no matter where Diaspora seed is located.
- Manage friends using 'aspects'.
- Upload photos and albums.
- All traffic is signed and encrypted (except photos, for now).

The public alpha of the project is still on course for October, which will include Facebook integration, internationalisation, as well as data portability.

The team writes in the blog-post, "Getting the source into the hands of developers is our first experiment in making a simple and functional tool for contextual sharing. Diaspora is in its infancy, but our initial ideas are there. Much of our focus this summer was centred around publishing content to groups of your friends, wherever their seed may live. It is by no means bug-free or feature complete, but is an important step for putting us, the users, in control."

When the Diaspora project was announced in April, Facebook was facing a backlash due to privacy issues and some of the changes being made. Amidst all this, Diaspora quickly gained support, reaching its initial US\$ 10,000 fundraising goal in 12 days. Kickstarter.com reveals Diaspora has raised \$ 200,641 from 6479 people.

Start developing on Diaspora if you want to, but note the team's warning:

"Feel free to try to get it running on your machines and use it, but we make no guarantees. We know there are security holes and bugs, and your data is not yet fully exportable. If you do find something, be sure to log it in our bugtracker, and we would love screenshots and browser info."

More at: <http://bit.ly/Diaspora-source>

The Android-powered Samsung Galaxy Tab is now out!

Another tablet arrives. This time it is the much anticipated Galaxy Tab, Samsung's latest addition to its Galaxy series. The Android-powered tablet made its very first appearance at 2010 IFA in Berlin, after Samsung had released a teaser video of the Galaxy Tab. The video confirmed many rumours surrounding the device: The 17.8-cm (7-inch) display will run Android Froyo and support Adobe Flash content, with an optimised version of Samsung's TouchWiz software and a 3.2-megapixel camera supporting video chat.

Here are some specs for your consideration:

- A 17.8-cm TFT-LCD display that has a 1024 x 600 pixel resolution.
- A 3.2-megapixel back-facing camera, and a 1.3 megapixel front-facing camera to make video calls.
- It is powered by a Cortex A8 1 GHz processor, tied to a PowerVR SGX540 graphics processor.
- A wide range of multimedia file types are supported and can play back HD video content.
- Two variants will be available: with 16 GB and 32 GB of internal memory.



Philips unveils first Android MP4 player

The rumours about a new MP4 portable media player (PMP) from Philips are true! The GoGear Connect player runs Google's open source OS, supports Wi-Fi and has an 8.1



cm (3.2-inch) touchscreen. Sources at Philips said: "The new Philips GoGear Connect takes the next step for MP4 players, being the first to offer the full Android experience. It comes pre-installed with Google Mobile applications and more than 100,000 apps can be downloaded from the Android Market." The gadget will be available in Western Europe, USA and China from October this year.

More at: <http://bit.ly/Philips-GoGear>

GWT Designer goes free!

Here is some good news for GWT (Google Web Toolkit) developers. Google has released GWT Designer, a powerful plug-in for Eclipse that allows developers to visualise their programmes, and those on Instantiations, for free. The Internet giant recently acquired Instantiations, known for its popular Java/Ajax development tools. Instantiations' development tools used to cost hundreds of dollars before the acquisition, reports claim.

More at: <http://bit.ly/GWT-Designer>

